

Four sounds your mouth has never made.

English has one **t** and one **d**. Odia has two of each, and they are different words. Getting them wrong is how everyone starts.

UNFINISHED — NEEDS AN ODIA SPEAKER

A tongue twister goes here.

Write it in the box below by hand, or add it to `TONGUE_TWISTER` in `content.py` so it also appears on screen and can be heard aloud. Nothing on this table should teach a child a word that hasn't been checked by someone who speaks the language.

IN ODIA SCRIPT

HOW IT SOUNDS

WHAT IT MEANS IN ENGLISH

Meanwhile — these four are checked, and they are the hard part.

ତା

ta

tongue **behind the teeth** —
soft, like Italian

ଟା

ṭa

tongue **curled back** on the
roof — hard, like English *t*

ଦା

da

tongue **behind the teeth** —
soft *d*

ଣା

ṇa

an **n** with the tongue curled
back — English has no such
letter

Curl the tongue back and you get the **retroflex** sounds — the ones that make an Indian accent sound Indian. Every Indian language has them; almost no European language does. **Tap ଡ and ଢ on the screen one after the other** and listen for the difference. Most people can't hear it the first time and can't stop hearing it after the third.

TRY IT

Say it slowly

Twice at half speed before you try it fast. Everyone who starts fast fails.

THEN

Say it to Smruti

She'll cheer you on. She can't grade your accent — no software here can.

THEN

Teach a friend

Explaining where your tongue goes is the moment you actually learn it.